Travancore would have to undergo at least one hugely costly *mahadanam* during his reign. This was in addition to other hugely costly ceremonies as the *thulapurusha danam*, in which the monarch was weighed on a large set of scales against an equal weight of gold, also distributed to the Brahmins.



The approach to the Padmanabhaswamy in Trivandrum, said to be the richest temple in India. Detail of a photograph taken by Zakaria d’Cruz, c. 1895.

